

# Harry Potter's London

12 Film & Book Locations · 3 Hours · King's Cross to Southwark

Beyond Platform 9¾, the real Harry Potter London is hiding in plain sight — the hospital where Harry is born is in the books, the Ministry of Magic entrance is a real red telephone box in Westminster, and Diagon Alley is a real street. This guide

YOU SAVE: £205 vs guided tours

### ■ WHAT THIS GUIDE SAVES YOU

Retail price of this guide  
**£14.99**

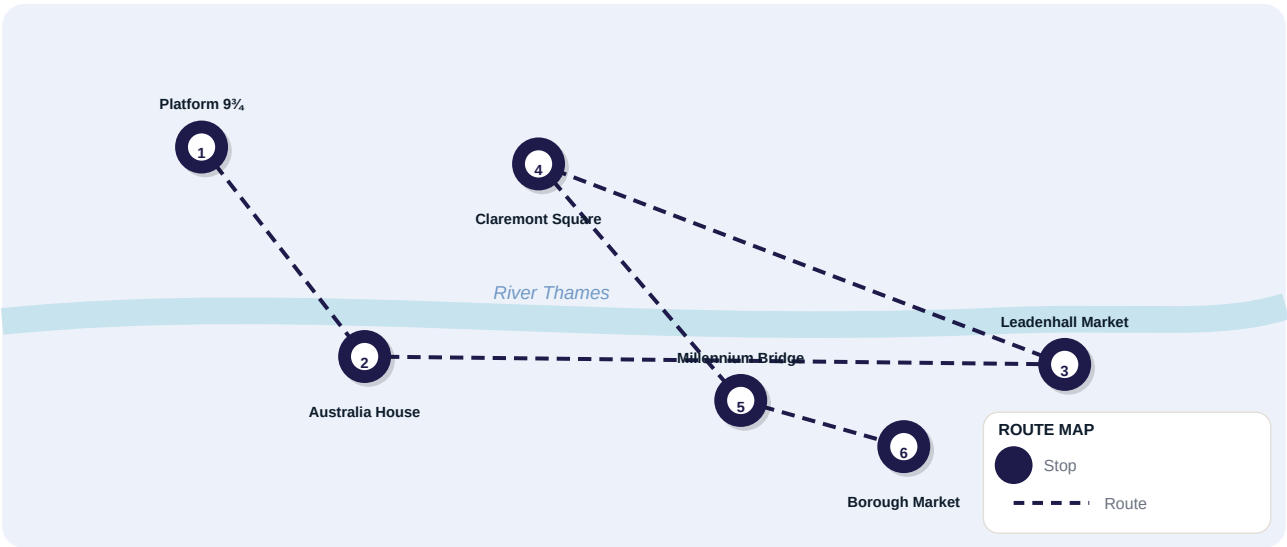
Equivalent guided tours  
**£220**

YOUR SAVING  
**£205**

### ROUTE INFO

|              |                                                                     |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ■ Start      | Platform 9¾ — King's Cross Station (King's Cross)                   |
| ■ End        | Borough Market — Slug & Jiggers (Leaky Cauldron Interior) (Borough) |
| ■ Duration   | 3 Hours                                                             |
| ■ Transport  | From central London: Zone 1–2 daily cap £8.10 covers all stops      |
| ■ Total Cost | Guide: £14.99 · Most stops FREE · See individual stop costs         |

### SCHEMATIC ROUTE MAP



### PRO TIPS — READ BEFORE YOU GO

|            |                                                            |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| ■ Best day | Tuesday–Thursday for fewer crowds at almost every location |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------|

|                       |                                                                              |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ■ <b>Saving</b>       | Pre-book anything with tickets — usually £2–4 discount per person            |
| ■ <b>Offline map</b>  | Download Google Maps offline before leaving your hotel                       |
| ■ <b>Transport</b>    | Use Contactless card — automatic daily cap (Zone 1: £8.10, Zone 1-2: £10.10) |
| ■ <b>Members only</b> | This guide is exclusive to London Lens lifetime subscribers                  |

# ■ COMPLETE STOP GUIDE — HARRY POTTER'S LONDON

Follow stops 1→6 in order for the best walking route. Each card includes insider tips, savings info, and the cheapest transport option.

1



## Platform 9¾ — King's Cross Station

King's Cross · Station: always open. Trolley photo: daily 8am–10pm

■ START HERE

**HIDDEN TIP**

The famous trolley photo point (Platform 9¾ between platforms 9 and 10) is free and always there — but has a 20–40 minute queue. Go on a weekday before 9am or after 4pm. The actual scene was filmed at platforms 4 and 5 but the 9¾ installation is the official spot.

■ SAVING

Studio Tour at Leavesden is £29 extra and needs a separate trip. London locations:

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

King's Cross St Pancras (2 min walk)  
Cost: Zone 1

**DO THIS:**

- ✓ Early morning for short queue at the trolley
- ✓ King's Cross Granary Square — 3 min walk, zero tourists
- ✓ The station itself (Victorian) is worth photographing

■ Best: Weekday before 9am — 5 min wait vs 40 min at noon

**AVOID:**

Saturday noon — 45 minute queue for a 10-second photo

★★★★■

Free · £29 Studio Tour (separate)

2



## Australia House — Gringotts Bank

Strand · Exterior always accessible

■ 25 min or tube

**HIDDEN TIP**

The interior of Australia House was used for the Gringotts Bank filming (Philosopher's Stone, 2001). The public cannot usually enter, but the exterior is identical to what you see in the film. The grand Edwardian entrance hall is occasionally open during Commonwealth events.

■ SAVING

HP guided tours walk past and charge £25.  
Free self-guided. Saving: £25

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Holborn (5 min walk) or Temple (5 min)  
Cost: Zone 1

**DO THIS:**

- ✓ Photograph the exterior — identical to Gringotts
- ✓ The Strand itself: unchanged since the Edwardian era
- ✓ Australia House open days — check australia.gov.au for public eve...

■ Best: Any time for the exterior

**AVOID:**

Expecting free interior access (usually Embassy only)

★★★★■

Free exterior

3



## Leadenhall Market — Diagon Alley

■ 20 min or tube

City of London · Market: Mon–Fri 10am–6pm. Exterior always open.

### HIDDEN TIP

The Victorian glass-roofed market was used as Diagon Alley and the entrance to the Leaky Cauldron in *Philosopher's Stone*. The Bull's Head passage (entrance from Whittington Avenue) is the exact shot from the film. The optician at 42 Bull's Head Passage was the Leaky Cauldron exterior.

#### ■ SAVING

HP walking tours: £25. This is free with our guide. Saving: £25

#### ■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Monument or Bank (5 min walk)  
Cost: Zone 1

### DO THIS:

- ✓ Bull's Head passage: the Leaky Cauldron entrance (42 Whittington Ave) — weekdays — City workers everywhere
  - ✓ The main market ceiling — film this from the centre
  - ✓ The market itself is extraordinary Victorian architecture
- Best: Early morning or evening when market quieter

### AVOID:

★★★★★

Free

4



## Claremont Square — 12 Grimmauld Place

■ 30 min or tube

Islington · Exterior always accessible

### HIDDEN TIP

The exterior of 12 Grimmauld Place (*Order of the Phoenix* film) was filmed at Claremont Square, Islington. Numbers 9–13 are the filming location. The square itself is a perfect early Victorian garden square — private garden for residents but the exterior walk is free.

#### ■ SAVING

HP tour includes this stop and charges £25. Free with our guide. Saving: £25

#### ■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Angel (10 min walk)  
Cost: Zone 1

### DO THIS:

- ✓ Find numbers 9-13 on the north side — exact film location Expecting to enter the private garden
  - ✓ The garden square exterior is beautiful Victorian architecture
  - ✓ Islington's Upper Street nearby for food
- Best: Any time — residential square

### AVOID:

★★★★■

Free exterior

5



## Millennium Bridge — Deathly Hallows

Bankside · Always open (pedestrian bridge)

■ 30 min or tube

### HIDDEN TIP

The Death Eaters destroy the Millennium Bridge in the opening sequence of Half-Blood Prince (2009). The actual bridge, linking Tate Modern to St Paul's, gives the most iconic view of both. Walk across at golden hour for the scene-matching light. The best free HP photo in London.

#### ■ SAVING

HP tours include this for £25. Free with our guide. Saving: £25

#### ■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Blackfriars (5 min walk) or Southwark  
Cost: Zone 1

#### DO THIS:

- ✓ Walk across for the Half-Blood Prince film angle
- ✓ St Paul's from the bridge — identical to the film establishing shot
- ✓ Tate Modern Level 10 (free) for the aerial perspective
- Best: Golden hour (sunset facing St Paul's, sunrise facing Tate)

#### AVOID:

Rainy days — though the Half-Blood Prince was rainy, so arguably atmos...

★★★★★

Free

6



## Borough Market — Slug & Jiggers (Diagon Alley)

Borough · Mon–Sat from 8am

■ 8 min walk from Millennium Bridge

### HIDDEN TIP

Borough Market's Winchester Walk was used for additional Diagon Alley scenes. The Victorian railway arches create the exact atmosphere of the wizarding world market. Walk through early morning when stalls are setting up and the stone cobbles and arched railway bridges make you feel genuinely in Rowling's

#### ■ SAVING

Free. HP tours charge £25. Saving: £25

#### ■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

London Bridge (5 min walk)  
Cost: Zone 1

#### DO THIS:

- ✓ Winchester Walk: Victorian railway arches — pure Diagon Alley
- ✓ Early morning for empty atmospheric photography
- ✓ The stone cobbles are original Victorian — same ones in the films
- Best: 7–9am Saturday when setting up begins

#### AVOID:

Any Saturday

★★★★★

Free entry

# QUICK REFERENCE CARD — CUT OUT OR SCREENSHOT

Summary of all stops for easy on-the-go reference.

| # | Name                      | Area           | Walk           | Cost       | Tube               | Rating |
|---|---------------------------|----------------|----------------|------------|--------------------|--------|
| 1 | Platform 9¾ — King's C... | King's Cross   | Start here     | Free · £29 | King's Cross St Pa | ★★★★■  |
| 2 | Australia House — Grin... | Strand         | 25 min or tube | Free exter | Holborn (5 min wal | ★★★★■  |
| 3 | Leadenhall Market — Di... | City of London | 20 min or tube | Free       | Monument or Bank ( | ★★★★★  |
| 4 | Claremont Square — 12 ... | Islington      | 30 min or tube | Free exter | Angel (10 min walk | ★★★★■  |
| 5 | Millennium Bridge — De... | Bankside       | 30 min or tube | Free       | Blackfriars (5 min | ★★★★★  |
| 6 | Borough Market — Slug ... | Borough        | 8 min walk fro | Free entry | London Bridge (5 m | ★★★★★  |

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